

केन्द्रीय विद्यालय संगठन, बेंगलुरु संभाग
KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN, BENGALURU REGION
प्री बोर्ड परीक्षा 2025-26
PRE-BOARD-EXAMINATION 2025-26

CLASS: X

MM: 80

SUBJECT: ENGLISH COMMUNICATIVE (101)

TIME: 3 Hrs.

General Instructions: Read the following instructions very carefully and follow them:

(i) The question paper is divided into **four** sections A, B, C and D.

Section A Reading Skills

22 marks

Section B Writing Skills

22 marks

Section C Grammar

10 marks

Section D Literature Textbook

26 marks

(ii) There are **12** questions in the question paper. All questions are compulsory.

(iii) Answers should be brief and to the point.

(iv) You may attempt any section at a time.

(v) All questions of that particular section must be attempted in the correct order.

	SECTION A (Reading Skills)	22 Marks
1.	Read the following passage carefully: -	12 M
	1. The word "local" has become synonymous with sustainability, whether it's food, clothes, or the materials used to construct buildings. But what about glass? The raw materials that go into glass - silica sand, soda ash and limestone are natural, but the sources of those materials are rarely known to the buyer. 2. The process by which sand becomes sheets of glass is often far from transparent. The sand, which makes up over 70% of glass, could come from a faraway riverbed, lake shore, or inland limestone outcrop. Sand with at least 95% silica content is called silica sand, and only the purest is suitable for architectural glass production. Such sand is found in limited areas. If the glass is colourless, its potential sources are even more limited, because colourless low iron glass - popularised by Apple's flagship stores and luxury towers around the world - requires 99% pure silica sand. 3. The mysteries of glass production have a historic precedent that can be traced back to the trade secrets of the Venetian Empire. Venice, particularly the island of Murano, became the centre for glass production largely due to its strategic location for importing raw materials, production know-how, and exporting coveted glass objects. From the 11th to the 16th Centuries, the secrets of glass making were protected by the Venetians until three glassmakers were smuggled out by King Louis XIV of France, who applied the technology to create the Palace of Versailles Hall of Mirrors. 4. Neither the primary materials of sand and soda ash (sodium carbonate) nor the firewood for the medieval Venetian glassmakers were found in the city's immediate vicinity. They were transported from the riverbeds of the Ticino River in Switzerland and the Agide River, which flows from the Austria-Switzerland border to the Adriatic Sea south of Venice. Soda ash, which is needed to lower the melting point of silica sand, was brought from Syria and	

	Egypt. So Venetian glass production was not local: it was dependent on precious resources imported from afar on ships. 5. In the past few decades, low-iron glass, known for its colourlessness, has become the contemporary symbol of high-end architecture. The glass appears to disappear. Low-iron glass is made from ultra-pure sand that is low in iron oxide. Iron causes the green tint seen in ordinary glass. In architecture, low-iron glass doesn't affect the performance - only the appearance. But it is prized. 6. In the U.S, this type of sand is found in a few locations, primarily in Minnesota, Wisconsin, Illinois, and Missouri, where sand as white and fine as sugar – thus called saccharoidal- is mined from St. Peter sandstone. Other locations where it can be found around the world include Queensland in Australia and parts of China. Less pure sand can be purified by methods such as acid washing or magnetic separation. Today, low-iron glass has become the standard for high-profile architecture. 7. Glass walls common in high-rise buildings today have other drawbacks. They help to heat the room during increasingly hot summers and contribute to heat loss in winter, increasing dependence on artificial cooling and heating. To bring Sand to its molten state, the furnace must be heated to over 2,700°F for as long as 50 hours, which requires burning fossil fuels such as natural gas, releasing greenhouse gases. Once heated to that temperature, the furnace runs 24/7 and is rarely shut down. 8. The soda ash and limestone also release carbon dioxide during melting. Moreover, glass production requires mining or producing non-renewable natural resources such as sand, soda ash, lime, and fuel. Transporting those further increases emissions. Production and fabrication of extra-large glass panels rely on specialised equipment and occurs only at a limited number of plants in the world, meaning transportation increases the carbon footprint. Architectural glass is also difficult to recycle, largely due to the labour involved in separating glass from the building assembly. 9. Although glass is touted as infinitely recyclable, only 6% of architectural glass is down cycled into glass products that require less purity and precision, and almost none is recycled into architectural glass. The rest ends up in landfills. The increasing demand for glass that is colourless, extra-large and seamless contributes to glass sustainability problem. Courtesy- (The author Aki Ishida, is Director, Graduate School of Architecture and Urban Design) - THE CONVERSATION	
Q1	Answer the following questions based on the above passage: -	
i)	Explain why the production of glass is not considered local.	2m
ii)	In about 30–40 words, explain why low-iron glass has become so popular in modern architecture.	2m
iii)	The demand for low-iron glass reflects that: (a) People prioritize energy efficiency over appearance. (b) Minimalist, seamless, and transparent aesthetics are highly valued. (c) Architects prefer tinted glass to reduce heat. (d) Colourful glass is cheaper and thus more popular.	1m

iv)	The Venetian glass industry shows that: (a) Glass production always depends on locally available materials. (b) Venice became famous mainly due to its abundant natural resources. (c) Strategic trade, secrecy, and skill, not resources, built Venice's glass reputation. (d) Venetian glassmakers exported sand to other countries.					1m
v)	Justify in about 40 words: "Architectural glass has a hidden environmental cost."					2m
vi)	Complete the following sentence appropriately: From this passage, we can infer that modern architectural choices often prioritise _____ over _____.					1m
vii)	State whether the following assertion is true or false "Architectural glass is infinitely recycled into new architectural glass."					1m
viii)	What is the main lesson about sustainability we can learn from this passage? (a) To promote the use of larger glass panels in buildings (b) To understand that even 'transparent' materials have hidden costs (c) To always replace ordinary glass with low-iron glass (d) To stop using glass entirely in architecture					1m
ix)	Find a word from Paragraph 2 that means <i>perfect or flawless</i> (a) Colourless (b) Purest (c) Transparent (d) Suitable					1m
2.	The Bookworms and the Storytellers					10 M
	Every student has a unique way of exploring the world, and often, the books they choose reveal their personalities, dreams, and hidden talents. The table below introduces four students whose reading habits not only shape their thinking but also fuel their creative and academic achievements. The table shows how books can be great inspirations to achieve your goals and mould your personality.					
	Student	English Mastery (out of 100)	Worlds They Explore Through Reading	Creative Sparks & Passions	Shining Moment	
	Ananya	92	Fiction (novels, short stories)	Storytelling, Creative Writing	Won 1st prize in Inter-School Short Story Contest	

Q2.	Rohit	78	Non-Fiction (science journals, biographies)	Quiz, Science Club	Represented school in National Science Quiz	
	Meera	88	Poetry and Drama	Theatre, Poetry Recitation	Starred as lead in Inter-School Drama Fest	
	Kunal	65	Newspapers and Magazines	Debating, Current Affairs	Awarded <i>Best Speaker</i> in Inter-School Debate Competition	
	Answer the following questions, based on the above table: -					
	i)	Identify the student who shows the strongest imaginative and artistic abilities.				1m
	ii)	Meera has a passion for poetry and drama. Which career option suits her best from the following? (A) Actor / Theatre Artist (B) Data Analyst (C) Sports Coach (D) Civil Engineer				1m
	iii)	Which interests of Kunal help him to develop confidence and stay updated with current events?				1m
	iv)	Give one justification each to prove that: (a) Ananya has exceptional command over language and storytelling. (b) Rohit is curious and enjoys exploring factual knowledge.				2m
	v)	Select the correct option to complete the analogy: Pen: Writing :: Stage: _____				1m
	vi)	Complete the sentence appropriately, with reference to the passage: From the table, we can infer that even though Kunal has the lowest English score, he is _____ than Ananya in public speaking.				1m
	vii)	Explain why situation (B) showcases Meera's teamwork and creative spirit (A) She performed a solo act in drama perfectly. (B) She collaborated with her classmates to ensure everyone played their role in the drama. (C) She memorized lines for a poetry recital only.				2m
	viii)	Choose the correct option which proves that Ananya excels in creative writing: (A) She writes short stories and won first prize in an inter-school contest. (B) She reads novels and writes short stories. (C) She writes short stories and won prizes in an inter-school contest.				1m

	SECTION B (Writing Skills)	22 Marks
Q3.	You are Anand/Amrita, a student of Class XI at Army Public School, Gandhinagar, Ahmedabad. Write an application to the principal requesting a change of section from XI-A to XI-B due to a change in subject. Give a suitable reason for your request.	3m
Q4.	Write a factual description of the new laptop that you purchased recently. (100 words)	4m
Q5a	Write a letter to the editor of a national daily, expressing your opinion and views on the increased human dependence on technology. Right from a small child to an adult, or even an old man, everyone wants gadgets -cell phones, i-pods, laptops, etc. This also has a negative effect on social relationships. Using your own ideas and the unit, 'Science', write the letter in 100-120 words.	7m
5 b	OR Despite initiatives like the 'Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan' and efforts to enroll underprivileged children in schools, a large number of children still remain out of school and have never experienced formal education. This situation is truly alarming. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily expressing your concern about this issue and suggesting measures to ensure education for all. Take ideas from the MCB unit "Education." Write your letter in about 100–120 words.	
Q6a	Tourism being one of the biggest and fastest growing industries globally, affects the economic, socio-cultural, environmental and educational resources of nations. Improving tourism industry in India would thus lead to national development in many spheres. Write an article for a magazine expressing your views on the same. You may take ideas from the unit- Travel and Tourism besides your own ideas. (150 words)	8m
6b	OR Disposal of electronic goods, commonly termed as e-waste, in landfills lead to toxic substances such as lead, mercury etc. contaminating the land, air and water. It's high time that countries take a stock of the situation and protect the environment. Write an article discussing the same. Also, suggest some solutions. You are Neha / Nitin. You may use ideas from the unit- Environment besides your own ideas (150 words)	
	SECTION C (Grammar)	10 Marks
Q7	Complete the following passage by choosing the correct options: - When I emerged (a) _____ (over/from/in) the anteroom, the waiting patients (b) _____ (looked/looking/looks) relieved. Outside (c) _____ (the/a/an) street I hesitated for a moment and turned my feet homeward.	3m
Q 8	In the following paragraph, one word has been omitted in each line. In your answer sheets, remember to write the missing word along with the word that comes before and after it, as shown.	4m

	No	Text	Word before	Omission	Word after	
	i	A man getting very impatient.				
	ii	Again and again, he would peep the				
	iii	doctor's room to see many patients				
	iv	were left. After a long time, his turn came, he heaved a sigh of relief.				
Q 9	Read the following dialogue between a mother and her son. Complete the paragraph that follows by filling in the gaps appropriately. Marie: Did you see my new umbrella? Isn't it fine? Tony: Yes, it is! Did you buy it from the mall? Marie: No, your father has brought it for me. Marie asked her son Tony (i) and she wanted to know whether it was a fine one. Tony agreed and asked his mother (ii) His mother replied in the negative and added that (iii)					3m
	SECTION D (Literature Textbook)					26 Marks
Q10	Read the following extracts given below and attempt ANY TWO: -					4+4m
a)	"One day, the postmaster's daughter became ill. He was eagerly waiting for a letter from her to know her well-being. When he saw the letter, he was expecting was his, he snatched it up and he got a shock by reading coachman Ali's name on it. Now as he was so anxious and sad for his daughter, his temperament had also changed."					
i)	How does the illness of the postmaster's daughter act as a turning point in the story?					
ii)	To what extent is the postmaster's realisation genuine empathy and to what extent is it self-centred fear? Substantiate with evidence.					
iii)	Identify the irony in the postmaster's delayed understanding of Ali's pain.					
iv)	Which word in the above line can be replaced with the word "distressed"?					
b)	"Day after day, day after day, We stuck, nor breath nor motion; As idle as a painted ship Upon a painted ocean".					

i) ii) iii) iv)	How does the poet use imagery here to heighten the sense of helplessness? How does this description reflect the state of the sailors? Identify the literary device used in the 3 rd line. Name the poem and the poet.	
c)	“Mrs. Slater: They’ll be here soon, so we must look smart. Put on your best frock, Victoria.”	
i) ii) iii) iv)	Why does Mrs. Slater ask Victoria to wear her best dress? What does this show about Mrs. Slater’s concern for appearances? How does Mrs. Slater’s behaviour reflect the hypocrisy in her attitude towards her father’s death? Give the synonym for ‘put on’.	
Q11	Answer any five of the following six questions in about 40 words each: -	5x2m
i) ii) iii) iv) v) vi)	How do Jacopo and Nicola show their dedication and love for their family member in ‘Two Gentlemen of Verona’? Why was the “Writer’s inspiration Bureau” formed? What message is conveyed by Vikram Seth through the poem “The Frog and the Nightingale”? Why did Mrs. Packletide’s remark “The incidental expenses are very heavy”? Discuss how Shakespeare's sonnet “Not Marble, nor the Gilded Monuments” conveys the theme of immortality through poetry. Patol Babu recalls to his mentor’s words. How did those words help him perform well?	
Q12	Answer any one of the following two questions in about 150 words:-	1x8m
a)	How do the poet in “The Snake” and Marcus Brutus in “Julius Caesar” struggle with inner conflict, and how does this influence the decisions they make? Discuss with reference to the themes of fear, societal pressure, and guilt.	
	OR	
b)	Both ‘A Shady Plot’ and ‘Patol Babu, Filmstar’ highlight the conflict between material gain and inner satisfaction. While John Hallock in “A Shady Plot” struggles with honesty and responsibility, Patol Babu shows dedication to art over money. What values do you learn from these stories about the true meaning of success and fulfilment in life? Illustrate with examples from both texts.	